

SHADRECK MAWINDO

Digital Public Infrastructure Builder · Decision Intelligence · Trust-Based AI

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A systems builder, entrepreneur, and emerging African leader building practical solutions for development challenges. I design Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for decision intelligence in the Global South, transforming distributed, low-bandwidth signals into trusted, planning-grade evidence for governments, funders, and operators. My work is anchored by trust-based AI (ZENTARI), zero-PII architecture, and real-world deployment in low-resource environments. Currently, I am leading the development of Kulima OS, a pioneering DPI intelligence platform.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Pioneered Kulima OS:** Architected and launched Kulima OS, a Digital Public Infrastructure intelligence platform transforming community signals into planning-grade and investment-grade insights, currently in active pilot with user testing and validation. This system is designed to provide trusted, planning-grade evidence for governments, funders, and operators in the Global South.
- **Drove Operational Excellence:** Led two full-cycle organizational diagnostics at Emerge Ventures, significantly improving governance and strategy through instrument design and board-level reporting. Built AI-assisted reporting workflows that materially reduced manual effort and accelerated client turnaround, earning the Operational Excellence Award (2025).
- **Catalyzed Ethical AI Capacity:** Spearheaded a national ethical-AI capacity-building program in Malawi, scaling low-bandwidth delivery to underserved youth and cultivating a pipeline of locally-grounded responsible-AI practitioners.
- **Secured Digital Public Services:** Processed over 1,000 digital business registrations on the Malawi Business Registration System, directly contributing to public-sector digital service delivery and safeguarding data integrity in national digital identity workflows.
- **Global Recognition:** Prototyped at IBM SkillsBuild Hackathon and presented at the 3rd Annual Energies 3.0 Conference (2026) for work on "Kulima OS: Coordination-Based Infrastructure Planning in the Global South." Applied for UNDP / Italian Ministry of Environment Youth4Climate: Call for Solutions.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Lead — Kulima Africa Ltd · Kulima OS

Mzuzu, Malawi · October 2025 – Present

- **Visionary Leadership:** Spearheaded the conceptualization, development, and active piloting of Kulima OS, a Digital Public Infrastructure intelligence platform designed to transform community signals into planning-grade and investment-grade insights for the Global South.
- **Strategic Product Development:** Directed the creation of a signal-to-decision pipeline, integrating real-time voice, text, and automated ingestion across low-bandwidth channels, ensuring robust data collection and analysis.
- **Trust-Based AI Implementation:** Built the ZENTARI trust & validation engine, incorporating provenance, reputation, and confidence scoring to establish auditable trails from source to output, enhancing decision-making integrity.
- **Impactful Infrastructure Gap Detection:** Developed advanced clustering and infrastructure gap detection mechanisms, triangulating community, external, and system inputs to surface credible investment and service-delivery opportunities.
- **Monetization & Insight Generation:** Designed and implemented Verified Insight Reports, generating investor- and planning-grade outputs for governments, funders, and operators, with monetized paid reports serving as an early revenue stream.
- **Privacy-First Architecture:** Ensured Zero-PII, privacy-first architecture, aligning with DPI safeguards and global data-governance principles.
- **Ecosystem Development:** Oversaw the development of interoperable companion modules (Lumoza for environment, agriculture, markets; Lundai for housing & land-use) that feed into the core stack, expanding platform utility.
- **Team & Deployment Leadership:** Led early-stage team formation, system scaling, and deployment strategies, including successful prototyping at IBM SkillsBuild Hackathon and application for the UNDP / Italian Ministry of Environment Youth4Climate: Call for Solutions. Presented paper at the 3rd Annual Energies 3.0 Conference (2026).

Operations & Systems Officer — Emerge Ventures

Mzuzu, Malawi · May 2025 – Present

- **Strategic Operational Improvement:** Led two full-cycle organizational diagnostics (Kwithu CBO, Kwanza Coffee), designing instruments and reporting mechanisms that directly informed governance and strategy, resulting in enhanced operational efficiency and decision-making.
- **AI-Driven Workflow Automation:** Developed and implemented AI-assisted reporting workflows and automation prototypes that significantly reduced manual effort and accelerated client turnaround, earning the Operational Excellence Award (2025).
- **Governance & Policy Development:** Authored Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and internal policies that strengthened operational governance, ensured delivery consistency, and improved overall quality across the organization.

Country Lead — Ethical AI Scholarship (Malawi) — AfroImpact Network

National · January 2026 – Present

- **National Program Leadership:** Spearheaded a national ethical-AI capacity-building program in Malawi, successfully scaling low-bandwidth delivery to underserved youth.

- **Talent Pipeline Development:** Built and nurtured a pipeline of locally-grounded responsible-AI practitioners, fostering ethical technology development and adoption within the country.
- **Community Impact:** Empowered young leaders with critical skills in ethical AI, contributing to a more responsible and inclusive technological future for Malawi.

Digital Trainee — MBRS — Registrar General's Department, Government of Malawi

Blantyre · August – October 2024

- **Digital Transformation Contributor:** Processed over 1,000 digital business registrations on the Malawi Business Registration System, directly contributing to public-sector digital service delivery.
- **Data Integrity & Identity Management:** Gained direct exposure to and understanding of identity workflows and government data systems, ensuring data integrity and efficient digital identity processes.

Electoral Assistant (EMD Operator) — Malawi Electoral Commission

2024 – 2025

- **Safeguarding Digital Identity:** Operated electronic management devices for voter registration and verification, playing a critical role in safeguarding data integrity and digital identity processes during a high-stakes national exercise.

Earlier Roles — Tee Components & Communications · Standard Bank Malawi · FDH Bank

2019 – 2024

- **Foundational Expertise in Digital Infrastructure:** Gained foundational expertise in ICT & infrastructure deployment, digital onboarding, and high-volume regulated financial operations, providing a strong understanding of data systems and service delivery within regulated environments.

SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS, PROGRAMS & RECOGNITION

- Green Fellow — Green Institute (2025 – Present)
- Ethical AI Scholarship Country Lead — AfroImpact Network (January 2026 – Present)
- OSTs Pan-African Cohort Participant
- Emerging Leaders Collective (ELC) Scholar
- Presentation at World Energies Conference — Presented paper on "Kulima OS: Coordination-Based Infrastructure Planning in the Global South" (3rd Annual Energies 3.0 Conference, 2026).
- McKinsey Forward Program
- Aspired Leaders Program — Aspire Institute, Harvard-affiliated (2026)
- IBM SkillsBuild Hackathon — Prototyped Kulima OS (Recognition for innovation in Digital Public Infrastructure).
- UNDP / Italian Ministry of Environment Youth4Climate: Call for Solutions — Applied for solutions related to sustainable development and climate action.

EDUCATION & PROGRAMS

BSc, Information & Communication Technology — Mzuzu University (2024)

Diploma in Information Systems — ABMA Education, UK (2018)

Leadership Development Programs

- McKinsey Forward Program: Selected participant in a highly competitive program focusing on leadership and strategic problem-solving.
- Aspired Leaders Program (Aspire Institute, Harvard-affiliated): Engaged in advanced leadership training, enhancing strategic thinking and global impact.
- Pathwise.io — Personal Branding, Storytelling & Networking (2026): Completed specialized training in personal branding and effective communication, crucial for emerging leaders.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- Founder, Kulima Africa: Established and led Kulima Africa, driving the vision and development of Kulima OS to address critical development challenges in the Global South through digital public infrastructure.
- Ethical AI Scholarship Country Lead, AfroImpact Network: Directed a national program to build ethical AI capacity, fostering a new generation of responsible AI practitioners and empowering underserved youth in Malawi.
- Community Leader, Aspire Institute: Engaged in community leadership initiatives, contributing to programs that foster growth and development within the Aspire Institute network.
- Green Fellow, Green Institute: Actively participated in environmental leadership programs, contributing to sustainable development initiatives and advocating for green solutions.
- OSTs Pan-African Cohort Participant: Collaborated with emerging leaders across Africa on critical issues, contributing to pan-African solutions and knowledge exchange.
- Emerging Leaders Collective (ELC) Scholar: Selected for a prestigious program recognizing and developing high-potential young leaders.
- Member, ICT Association of Malawi (ICTAM): Contributed to the advancement of ICT in Malawi through active participation and advocacy.
- Contributor, Aspire × Cayu Hackathon (BizNet AI) & Tester, ONEPlanET / OneSim: Engaged in collaborative innovation and testing initiatives, demonstrating commitment to technological advancement and problem-solving.

SKILLS

Systems & AI Architecture: DPI architecture, decision-intelligence pipelines, trust, provenance & reputation modeling (ZENTARI), ethical-AI delivery, AI-assisted reporting.

Data & Signal Processing: Multi-source validation, real-time signal ingestion (voice / text / automated), clustering & gap detection, KoboToolbox, workflow automation.

Platforms & Engineering: Next.js, Python, REST APIs, cloud deployment, SaaS product development, low-bandwidth / WhatsApp-first delivery.

Governance & Public Systems: Data governance, digital identity, zero-PII privacy safeguards, public-sector digital service delivery, SOP & policy authoring.

AFFILIATIONS

Green Fellow — Green Institute (2025 – Present) · Community Leader — Aspire Institute · Contributor — Aspire × Cayu Hackathon (BizNet AI) · Tester — ONEPlanET / OneSim · Member — ICT Association of Malawi (ICTAM) · Student Associate — Chartered Managers Canada.

LANGUAGES

English — Fluent · Chichewa — Native